Barcelona & Porto — Family Itinerary

29 May – 5 June 2026 · 5 adults · Mid-range budget

8	2	5
nights total	cities	adults

BARCELONA Spain

29 May – 1 Jun

Fri 29 May ✈ Arrival + Gothic Quarter

Food Culture ▲

08:00 Arrive El Prat Airport (BCN)
Take the Aerobus (€6.75/person) to Plaça Catalunya — fastest, no stops. Drop bags at hotel/apartment.

10:30 La Boqueria Market
Barcelona's iconic covered market on Las Ramblas. Grab fresh fruit, jamón, local olives and a quick market breakfast. Arrive early before crowds peak.

12:00 Gothic Quarter (Barri Gòtic) stroll
Wander the medieval labyrinth — Plaça Reial, Barcelona Cathedral, Pont del Bisbe. Free and unmissable.

14:00 Lunch at El Xampanyet
Classic cava bar in El Born. Order the house cava, patatas bravas, croquetas and pa amb tomàquet. Budget ~€20–25pp.

16:00 El Born & Picasso Museum
Explore the trendy El Born district. Visit Picasso Museum (book online in advance, ~€15pp) or browse the boutique shops nearby.

19:30 Barceloneta Beach sunset + tapas dinner
Walk to the beach for golden hour. Dinner at La Cova Fumada (locals-only spot, cash only) or Bar Electricitat for grilled seafood and vermouth.

> 💡 Book Picasso Museum and Sagrada Família tickets online before you travel — they sell out weeks in advance, especially in late May/June.

Sat 30 May 🏛 Gaudí Day — Sagrada Família + Park Güell

Culture Outdoor ▲

08:30 Sagrada Família (first entry)
Book the earliest slot — the morning light through the stained glass on the Nativity facade is extraordinary. Guided tour + tower access recommended (~€36pp). Allow 2 hours.

11:30 Recinte Modernista de Sant Pau
A UNESCO-listed art nouveau hospital 5 min walk from Sagrada Família — stunning architecture with far fewer crowds. ~€16pp.

13:30 Lunch in Gràcia neighbourhood

Walk or metro to Gràcia — the most authentically local barrio. Try La Pepita for creative montaditos or El Glop for hearty Catalan cuisine (~€20–30pp).

15:30 **Park Güell**

The ticketed Monumental Zone must be pre-booked (~€10pp). Arrive for your timed slot, enjoy the mosaic terrace and gingerbread gatehouses. Stunning city views.

18:00 **Passeig de Gràcia & Casa Batlló**

Walk down the famous boulevard — see Casa Batlló (exterior free, interior ~€35pp), Casa Milà/La Pedrera and the Block of Discord. World-class luxury shopping here too.

20:30 **Dinner at Cervecería Catalana**

Excellent tapas and pintxos on Carrer de Mallorca. Expect a queue but worth it — order the aubergine with honey and the bombas. ~€25–35pp.

💡 Barcelona's "magic hour" dinner is 9–10pm. Don't be alarmed by early empty restaurants — that's normal!

Sun 31 May ▲ Montserrat Day Trip

Outdoor Culture ▲

08:30 **Train from Plaça Espanya**

Take the R5 FGC train to Monistrol de Montserrat, then the rack railway (cremallera) up the mountain. Journey ~1hr 15min. Buy the Trans Montserrat pass (~€36pp) — includes round-trip train + rack railway + funiculars.

10:00 **Montserrat Monastery & Black Madonna**

The 11th-century monastery perched dramatically on jagged rock spires. See the iconic La Moreneta statue. Try to catch the Escolania boys choir (Mon–Fri 1pm, Sun 12pm).

11:30 **Sant Joan Funicular + hiking trail**

Ride up to 1,100m and hike the ridge trail to Sant Joan hermitage (easy 30-min walk). Breathtaking panoramic views of Catalonia. Sturdy shoes essential.

13:30 **Lunch on the mountain**

Pick up local cheese, sausage and the famous Montserrat "monk's cheese" from the market stalls. Or dine at Restaurant de Montserrat (~€25–35pp).

15:00 **Santa Cova Funicular trail**

Ride down to the Santa Cova chapel trail — a dramatic cliff-side path with Gaudí-era sculptures. Only 45 mins round trip.

17:00 **Return to Barcelona**

Back in Barcelona by 6:30pm. Evening free — explore Montjuïc's Magic Fountain show (free, 9:30pm on weekends in summer) if energy allows.

💡 Montserrat is very popular on Sundays. Start early (8:30am train) to beat the crowds and enjoy the trails before it gets busy.

Mon 1 Jun ✈ Montjuïc Morning → Fly to Porto

Outdoor Transit ▲

09:00 **Montjuïc by cable car + Castle**

Take the Port Cable Car up to Montjuïc for sweeping harbour views. Visit the Castle (~€9pp) and Jardins de Laribal botanical gardens. A peaceful morning away from the crowd.

11:30 **Poble Espanyol & last-minute shopping**

The "Spanish Village" open-air museum houses artisan workshops — great for souvenirs. ~€14pp. Or browse the El Born boutiques for one final shop.

13:00 **Lunch & head to airport**
Quick lunch near hotel, collect bags, Aerobus to BCN airport. Allow 90 mins before departure.

~16:00 **Fly Barcelona → Porto (OPO)**
~2hr flight. From Porto airport, take the Metro Line E (purple) directly to central Porto — ~35 mins, ~€2pp. No need for a taxi.

19:00 **Check in + São Bento Station visit**
Drop bags (stay in Clérigos or Ribeira area). Walk 5 mins to São Bento Station — one of the world's most beautiful train stations, with 20,000 azulejo tiles. Free, open daily.

20:30 **First dinner in Porto — Francesinha!**
Café Santiago (Rua de Passos Manuel) is Porto's most famous Francesinha spot — the city's iconic meat-and-cheese sandwich in a spiced beer sauce. ~€15–18pp.

💡 Stay in the Clérigos or Ribeira neighbourhood in Porto — central, walkable, and you'll be close to everything.

PORTO Portugal

1–4 Jun

Tue 2 Jun 🏘️ Historic Porto — Ribeira & Gaia Wine Cellars

Culture Wine Food ▲

09:00 **Porto Food & Wine Morning Tour**
Join the "Porto Food & Vintage Port Wine Tour" from Mercado do Bolhão — 3.5 hours, 13 tastings, one of the highest-rated food tours in Europe. Book ahead (~€75pp).

12:30 **Ribeira District & Porto Cathedral (Sé)**
Walk the colourful riverside neighbourhood. Climb up to the 12th-century Cathedral — free entry, €3 for the azulejo cloister. Best views of the Douro River from the terrace.

14:30 **Cross Dom Luís I Bridge → Vila Nova de Gaia**
Walk across the iconic iron bridge (upper deck for the best views). Head into the famous Port wine cellars on the south bank — Taylor's, Graham's and Sandeman are all excellent (~€15–25pp with tasting).

17:00 **Douro River Six Bridges Cruise**
Board a rabelo boat for the classic "6 Bridges Cruise" — ~1 hour sailing under all the city's bridges from a water-level view. €15–18pp, boats run 11am–4pm.

18:30 **Gaia Cable Car + sunset viewpoint**
Ride the Teleférico de Gaia up to Miradouro da Serra do Pilar (~€6pp) for the best sunset panorama of Porto. Photographers' dream.

20:30 **Dinner at Mercado Bom Sucesso**
Buzzy food hall with multiple vendors — great for groups where everyone wants something different. Octopus, bacalhau, petiscos (Portuguese tapas). ~€20–30pp.

💡 Port wine is 20% alcohol — it sneaks up on you! Pace yourselves during the morning food tour and afternoon cellar visits.

Wed 3 Jun 🍇 Douro Valley Day Trip

Outdoor Wine Food ▲

08:00 **Depart Porto for Douro Valley**

Book a guided day tour from Porto (~€70–90pp) — includes transport, wine tastings and lunch. Alternatively, take the scenic Douro train line from São Bento to Pinhão (~2.5hrs, ~€12pp each way) — one of Europe's most beautiful rail journeys.

10:30 **Quinta do Crasto or Quinta do Vallado**

Visit one of the region's top organic quintas (wine estates). Tour the terraced vineyards, learn about the harvest and taste Douro whites, reds and vintage Port. The scenery — UNESCO-listed terraced hillsides — is jaw-dropping.

13:00 **Lunch with Douro River views**

Traditional Portuguese lunch at a quinta restaurant — expect bacalhau à brás, roasted lamb and local wines. Usually included in guided tours or ~€25–35pp independently.

15:00 **Village of Pinhão & river cruise**

Explore the charming Pinhão village (famous for its azulejo-decorated train station). Optional short boat ride on the Douro through the valley.

17:30 **Return to Porto**

Back in Porto by 7–7:30pm. A more relaxed evening — perfect for a quiet dinner.

20:00 **Fado show + dinner**

End your Porto stay with a Fado performance — Casa da Mariquinhas or Ideal Clube de Fado are authentic venues. Deeply moving Portuguese soulful music. ~€15–20pp entry.

💡 Book the Douro Valley tour at least 2 weeks ahead — the best quintas and guided tours sell out fast in June.

Thu 4 Jun

🗺️ Porto Morning → Back to Barcelona

Culture Shopping Transit ▲

09:00 **Livraria Lello — the famous bookshop**

One of the world's most beautiful bookshops — a neo-Gothic 1906 masterpiece. Queue early to get good photos. Entry €5pp (redeemable against purchase).

10:30 **Clérigos Tower + Palácio da Bolsa**

Climb the 225 steps of the Baroque Clérigos Tower for 360° city views (~€5pp). Then visit the stunning Arab Room inside Palácio da Bolsa (~€5pp).

12:00 **Rua de Santa Catarina shopping**

Porto's main pedestrian shopping street — mix of local boutiques, Portuguese ceramics, cork products and international brands. Great for last-minute souvenirs.

13:00 **Farewell lunch — Bacalhau à Brás**

Try the classic salted cod dish at Cantinho do Avillez or Brasão Aliados. ~€20–25pp. Then metro to airport (Line E, 35 mins).

~18:00 **Fly Porto → Barcelona**

~2hr flight back. Check in to your Barcelona hotel/apartment for the final two nights.

21:00 **Final Barcelona night out**

Head to El Born or Poble Sec for tapas and cocktails. Bodega Sepúlveda, Bar Calders or a classic vermouth bar in the Raval neighbourhood.

Fri 5 Jun

🌅 Final Morning — Departure by 11am

Food Transit ▲

07:30

Final breakfast in Barcelona

Café croissant and cortado at a local granjería. If staying near Eixample, try Federal Café or Alsur Café for a proper last morning.

09:00

Collect bags & Aerobus to BCN airport

Aerobus departs from Plaça Catalunya every 5–10 minutes. Journey ~35 mins. Arrive airport with 90 minutes to spare before any departure.

💡 The Aerobus to the airport takes 35 mins — for an 11am departure, aim to leave your hotel no later than 8:45am.